

25 June 2024

Ref: CL/4475

Subject: **First consultation on the implementation of the 2021 Recommendation on Open Science**

Madam/Sir,

Under Article VIII of UNESCO's Constitution, Member States are required to submit regular reports on the measures they have taken to implement the conventions and recommendations adopted by the Organization.

In this context, I invite your Government to submit its report on the 2021 Recommendation on Open Science, in English or French, **no later than 28 February 2025**. Attached you will find guidelines to assist your authorities in submitting the report. Regional online sessions will also be organized to provide further guidance on report preparation.

Member States are encouraged to organize all necessary consultations with relevant ministries and institutions as well as with key stakeholders, including professional associations, civil society partners, private sector entities and National Commissions for UNESCO.

In addition, Member States are requested to designate a contact person responsible for information sharing and cooperation with UNESCO regarding reports on the 2021 Recommendation on Open Science. Member States should inform the Secretariat of this designation by 20 July 2024 at the latest at: openscience@unesco.org.

The Secretariat will present the first global report on Member States' application of this Recommendation for examination at the 222nd session of the Executive Board in autumn 2025. This report, together with the comments of the Committee on Conventions and Recommendations, will subsequently be submitted to the 43rd session of the General Conference in 2025.

The Natural Sciences Sector remains at your disposal for any further information you may require.

Please accept, Madam/Sir, the assurances of my highest consideration.

Audrey Azoulay
Director-General

Encl.: *Guidelines for the preparation of the reports from Member States on the implementation of the 2021 Recommendation on Open Science*

cc: Permanent Delegations to UNESCO
National Commissions for UNESCO
UNESCO regional offices
UNESCO field offices

To Ministers responsible for relations with UNESCO

ANNEX

GUIDELINES FOR THE PREPARATION OF THE REPORTS FROM MEMBER STATES ON THE IMPLEMENTATION OF THE 2021 RECOMMENDATION ON OPEN SCIENCE

I. INTRODUCTION

These Guidelines are intended to assist Member States in the preparation of the reports on the implementation of the 2021 Recommendation on Open Science (hereinafter referred to as “the 2021 Recommendation”) that was adopted by the 41st session of the General Conference of UNESCO on 23 November 2021.

The 2021 Recommendation proposes seven areas of action: (i) promoting a common understanding of open science, associated benefits and challenges, as well as diverse paths to open science; (ii) developing an enabling policy environment for open science; (iii) investing in open science infrastructures and services; (iv) investing in human resources, training, education, digital literacy and capacity building for open science; (v) fostering a culture of open science and aligning incentives for open science; (vi) promoting innovative approaches for open science at different stages of the scientific process; (vii) promoting international and multi-stakeholder cooperation in the context of open science and with view to reducing digital, technological and knowledge gaps.

For the purpose of the 2021 Recommendation, open science is defined as an inclusive construct that combines various movements and practices aiming to make multilingual scientific knowledge openly available, accessible and reusable for everyone, to increase scientific collaborations and sharing of information for the benefits of science and society, and to open the processes of scientific knowledge creation, evaluation and communication to societal actors beyond the traditional scientific community. It comprises all scientific disciplines and aspects of scholarly practices, including basic and applied sciences, natural and social sciences and the humanities, and it builds on the following key pillars: open scientific knowledge, open science infrastructures, science communication, open engagement of societal actors and open dialogue with other knowledge systems.

Pursuant to Articles 15 and 16.1 of the Rules of Procedure concerning recommendations to Member States and international conventions covered by the terms of Article IV, paragraph 4, of the UNESCO Constitution, the Director-General of UNESCO has invited Member States by the Circular Letter (CL/4381) to submit the 2021 Recommendation to their competent authorities within a period of one year from the close of the session of the General Conference at which it was adopted, i.e. before 24 November 2022.

Furthermore, under Article VIII of UNESCO’s Constitution, Member States are required to submit a report on the action taken upon the conventions and recommendations adopted by the General Conference.

II. WHAT ARE THE AIMS OF THIS CONSULTATION?

This global consultation aims to assist Member States in: (1) mapping policies, mechanisms and actions related to open science and all its key pillars, against the objectives of this Recommendation; (2) collecting and disseminating progress and good practices on open science; (3) identifying challenges and opportunities faced by Member States in the implementation of the Recommendation, so as to identify specific capacity-building needs.

III. HOW TO FILL IN THE QUESTIONNAIRE?

The following questionnaire, which was developed with inputs from UNESCO working group on open science monitoring framework, aims to guide and assist Member States with their reporting on the progress made in the implementation of the 2021 Recommendation. It aims to collect information on the extent to which Member States have integrated the core values and guiding principles of open

science that are defined in the 2021 Recommendation, in their national science, technology and innovation systems. Responses to this questionnaire will be considered as the official national report of each Member State.

Prior to completing the questionnaire, Member States are encouraged to organize the necessary consultations within and outside the concerned ministries and institutions, including with authorities and bodies responsible for science, technology and innovation, and consult relevant actors concerned with open science, including the scientific community, professional associations, civil society, indigenous and traditional knowledge holders, private sector partners and National Commissions for UNESCO.

In the preparation of their reports, Member States are also encouraged to consult the UNESCO Open Science Toolkit and the first edition of the *UNESCO Open Science Outlook* (published December 2023) containing a collection of information and communication materials relevant to the implementation of the 2021 Recommendation on Open Science. These resources are available online at <https://www.unesco.org/en/open-science/toolkit> and <https://unesdoc.unesco.org/ark:/48223/pf0000387324>.

Member States are requested to designate a contact person responsible for information sharing and cooperation with UNESCO in relation to reporting on the 2021 Recommendation.

Member States are encouraged to submit the questionnaire (in English or French) in one of the following ways:

- (i) Online (preferred): the consolidated questionnaire (one per Member State) can be completed and submitted [online](#).
- (ii) Email: the questionnaire can be completed electronically and sent to: openscience@unesco.org

The responses to the questionnaire, if sent by email, should not exceed 15 pages, excluding annexes and is to be submitted to UNESCO in electronic form only (standard .doc, .pdf or .rtf format).

The reports will be made available on UNESCO's website in order to facilitate the exchange of information relating to the promotion and implementation of this Recommendation.

IV. DRAFT QUESTIONNAIRE

A. GENERAL INFORMATION ABOUT THE RESPONDANT:

- Country*: South Africa
 - Organization(s) or entity(ies):
- Sector: ☒ Public ☐ Private ☐ Civil Society ☐ Other

B. Questionnaire for Member States' reporting on the implementation of the 2021 Recommendation

1. PROMOTING A COMMON UNDERSTANDING OF OPEN SCIENCE, ASSOCIATED BENEFITS, AND CHALLENGES, AS WELL AS DIVERSE PATHS TO OPEN SCIENCE

- 1.1 Has the 2021 [Recommendation](#) been promoted and/or shared with appropriate ministries and institutions as well as affiliated organizations in your country?

YES / NO

If **yes**, please indicate which ministries and/or national authorities/entities have been involved in the promotion of the 2021 Recommendation.

- **Department of Science, Technology and Innovation**
- **Department of Higher Education and Training**
- **National Research Foundation (NRF) of South Africa**
- **Universities South Africa (network of all universities in the country)**
- **All the 26 Public Universities**
- **Committee of Higher Education Libraries of South AfricaSouth African National Library and Information Consortium**
- **African Scientists Directory through The Academy of Science of South Africa (ASSAf)**
- **Academy of Science of South Africa (ASSAf)**

If **no**, please, if possible, briefly explain the reason and the difficulties or obstacles in this area and indicate if there are plans to do so.

- 1.2 Is the 2021 Recommendation on Open Science available in the national language(s) of your country?

YES / NO

If **yes**, which language(s)?

English but not in the indigenous languages

- 1.3 Have there been awareness raising activities on open science, including all its key elements¹, associated benefits and challenges, organized or foreseen to be organized by the end of 2025 in your country by national authorities or entities? (ref.: [\(i\) 16.f, 16.g, 16.h](#))

YES / NO

If **yes**, please provide details on the activities organized or foreseen and links as relevant.

- **National Science Week (NSW) championed by the South African Agency for Science and Technology Advancement (SAASTA).**
- **Universities hold events on Open access Week to celebrate open scholarship, including open science**
- **A number of session on OS during the South African Science Forum (a policy dialogue)**
- **Department of Science and Technology Science Engagement Strategy Implementation plan**
- **Academy of Science of South Africa (ASSAf)**
- **Department of Science and Innovation**
- **Africa Open Science Platform (AOSP)**
- **National Research Foundation**
- **SANLIC**
- **LIASA**
- **In general advocacy about Open Science is shared**

¹ Please refer to the elements of open science defined in the 2021 Recommendation, namely : [open scientific knowledge](#) (including open access to scientific publications, research data, open educational resources, open-source software and code, open hardware), [open science infrastructures](#), [open engagement of societal actors](#) and [open dialogue with other knowledge systems](#).

- 1.4 Have specific actions been undertaken or are planned to be undertaken by end of 2025 in your country to incorporate the values and principles of open science², in publicly funded research? (ref.: [\(i\) 16.a, 16.b, 16.c, 16.d, 16.e, 16.h](#))

YES / NO

If **yes**, please indicate the actions that are taken to incorporate the specific values and principles. For each case, please provide details and links as relevant.

- ***Draft Open Science Policy (Currently with the ministerial Cluster after extensive consultation)***
- ***Open Science Framework for South Africa articulates a set of guidelines and principles for publicly funded open science and open data for the South African context.***
- ***Universities have embraced and implemented open access policies***
- ***African Virtual University***
- ***The African Open Science Platform (AOSP) (<https://council.science/current/news/the-national-research-foundation-of-south-africa-to-host-the-african-open-science-platform/>)***
- ***DataFirst (<https://www.datafirst.uct.ac.za/>)***
- ***Square Kilometer Array (SKA) project and the new Multi-Purpose***
- ***Reactor (MPR)***
- ***Event promoting open Access (<https://doasummit.uct.ac.za/open-science-in-the-south-2024/>)***

If **no**, please, if possible, briefly explain the reason and the difficulties or obstacles in this area and indicate if there are plans to do so?

2. DEVELOPING AN ENABLING POLICY ENVIRONMENT FOR OPEN SCIENCE

- 2.1 Does your country have a national policy³, strategy or plan of action on science, technology and innovation (STI)?

YES / NO

If **yes**

- please attach/upload a machine-readable PDF file of the policy and provide the following information: *Title of the policy, the authority in charge of development of the policy, entities involved and the process of development, year of adoption, year of last update, key areas/sections of the policy, and links to the webpage if available.*
- does it include any of the following open science elements:

² The 2021 Recommendation outlines a set of shared values of open science stemming from the rights-based, ethical, epistemological, economic, legal, political, social, multi-stakeholder and technological implications of opening science to society and broadening the principles of openness to the whole cycle of scientific research. It also provides a set of guiding principles, as a framework for enabling conditions and practices, which uphold the values of open science and can realize the ideals of open science. Please see the [values of open science](#), namely quality and integrity, collective benefit, equity and fairness, and diversity and inclusiveness.

Please see the [guiding principles for open science](#), namely transparency, scrutiny, critique and reproducibility; equality of opportunities; responsibility, respect and accountability; collaboration, participation and inclusion; flexibility and sustainability.

³ National STI policy is most commonly a governmental document developed by governing bodies leading the STI policy design and implementation in a given country, which formulates objectives and guides actions and decision-making processes in the area of STI on the national level.

- **open access to scientific knowledge**
- **open science infrastructure**
- **open engagement of societal actors**
- **open dialogue with other knowledge systems**

If **no**, please, if possible, briefly explain the reason and the difficulties or obstacles in this area and indicate if there are plans to do so.

- 2.2 In your country, is there a policy, or a set of policies and/or legal framework(s)⁴ at the national level that address open science or any of its key elements in line with the definition, values and principles outlined in the 2021 Recommendation on Open Science? (ref.: [\(i\) 16.a, 16.b, 16.c, 16.d, 16.e, 16.h](#))

YES / PARTLY / NO

If **yes or partly**, please attach/upload machine-readable PDF file(s) of the policy(ies) and provide the following information for each: *Title of the policy or legal instrument, the authority in charge of development of the policy, entities involved and the process of development, year of adoption, year of last update, key areas/sections of the policy, elements of open science that are addressed, and links to the webpage(s) if available.*

If **no**, please, if possible, briefly explain the reason and the difficulties or obstacles in this area and indicate if there are plans to develop such policies.

- 2.3 In your country, are there specific policy instruments⁵ that aim to promote open science?

YES/ UNDER DEVELOPMENT/ NO

If **yes or under development**, please provide details and links as relevant, including for each instrument: *Title of the instrument, its objective, the authority in charge, allocated budget, elements of open science included.*

YES

- National Research Foundation (NRF)
- Academy of Science of South Africa (ASSAf)
- University of Pretoria, Stellenbosch University, Sefako Makgatho Health Sciences University, and Durban University of Technology
- Absa Data Science and Engineering Academy

• **UNDER DEVELOPMENT**

- **OS Policy Draft**

If **no**, please, if possible, briefly explain the reason and the difficulties or obstacles in this area and indicate if there are plans to develop such policy instruments.

⁴ These can include specific national policies, sets of guidelines, rules, regulations, laws, principles, or directions to govern open science practices.

⁵ Policy instruments include programmes, methods and mechanisms of technical and operational nature, required to solve the issues set by the policy, with focus on the target beneficiaries, resources, indicators, and set of goals for delivering products (short term), results (medium-term), and impacts (long term).

- 2.4 In your country, is there a national implementation plan, strategy, policy or a roadmap for implementation of open science at the national level in line with the 2021 Recommendation? (ref.: [\(ii\) 17.a, 17.b, 17.c, 17.f, 17.h](#))

YES / **UNDER DEVELOPMENT** / NO

If **yes or under development**, please provide details and links as relevant, including the name of ministries and national authorities/entities, as well as affiliated organizations that are involved in the development and implementation of the plan, strategy or the roadmap.

YES

- *Department of Science, Technology and Innovation (DSTI) has developed the Science Engagement Monitoring and Evaluation Impact Indicator Framework*
- *NRF and DHET documents*

UNDER DEVELOPMENT

- *A draft policy document has been discussed*

If **no**, please, if possible, briefly explain the reason and the difficulties or obstacles in this area and indicate if there are plans to develop such policy instruments.

- 2.5 In your country, are there policies and/or strategies that promote open science in line with the 2021 Recommendation at **institutional** level, including in the context of research-performing institutions, universities, scientific unions and associations and learned societies? (ref.: [\(ii\) 17.d, 17.e, 17.g](#))

YES / **UNDER DEVELOPMENT** / NO

If **yes**, please provide more information, including the number of policies, name of the institute(s) that has/have developed the policy(s) and [elements of open science](#), included in the policy (please consider policies and strategies addressing all elements of open science, including citizen and participatory science, or co-production of knowledge with multiple actors).

- *University of Pretoria, Stellenbosch University, Sefako Makgatho Health Sciences University, and Durban University of Technology: These institutions collaborate with organizations like PLOS (Public Library of Science) and the Training Centre in Communication (TCC Africa) to promote open science practices and policies.*
- *Various agencies*
- *University research policies*
- <https://www.assaf.org.za/wp-content/uploads/2024/02/ASSAf-Open-Science-Policy.pdf>

- 2.6 In your country, are there specific funding mechanisms⁶ for open science at the national level? (ref.: [\(ii\) 17.i, \(iii\) 18.i, \(iv\) 19.c](#))

YES / **UNDER DEVELOPMENT** / NO

If **yes or under development**, please provide details and links as relevant.

⁶ A funding mechanism refers to a policy instrument or process through which financial resources are allocated or provided for a specific purpose. Some examples are block funding, research grants, support for technological poles and centres of excellence, support for science parks and innovation centres, Infrastructure grants (for research facilities, labs, instruments), communication and outreach funds, innovation funds, loans and tax credits scholarships, studentships, fellowships, trust funds, sectoral funds.

- **Department of Science and Innovation (DSI) has developed the Science Engagement Monitoring and Evaluation Impact Indicator Framework**
- **NRF, TIA, MRC and various setas e.g. CHIETA, HWSETA**
- **It through SANLiC consortia of universities and Science Councils subscriptions through Transformative Agreements**
- <https://www.nrf.ac.za/call-extension-for-the-establishment-of-the-african-open-science-platform-aosp-regional-nodes/?hilite=open+science>

If **no**, please, if possible, briefly explain the reason and the difficulties or obstacles in this area and indicate if there are plans to develop such funding mechanisms.

- 2.7 In your country, have open science practices⁷ been integrated in existing research funding mechanisms?

YES / NO

If **yes**, please provide details and links as relevant.

- **National Research Foundation (NRF) and the Academy of Science of South Africa (ASSAf) are key players in this integration**
- <https://www.assaf.org.za/wp-content/uploads/2024/02/ASSAf-Open-Science-Policy.pdf>
- **Transformative Agreements**
- **MRC and universities**

If **no**, please, if possible, briefly explain the reason and the difficulties or obstacles in this area and indicate if there are plans to do so.

- 2.8 Have efforts been made or are foreseen to be undertaken by end of 2025 in your country to foster equitable public-private partnerships on open science in line with the 2021 Recommendation? (ref.: [\(ii\) 17.i](#))

YES / NO

If **yes**, please provide details and links as relevant.

- **STI plan, NDP2030, etc**
- **University partnerships with external stakeholders**
- <https://www.nrf.ac.za/second-open-access-essay-competition-2024-africa-region-community-over-commercialisation-for-diamond-open-access/?hilite=open+science>

If **no**, please, if possible, briefly explain the reason and the difficulties or obstacles in this area and indicate if there are plans to do so.

- **A fragmented approach where sectors work in Silos**
- **There might be SOME public-private projects which include open-science, but I'm not aware of a general effort.**

- 2.9 Is there a national monitoring framework for open science in your country? Or are there specific indicators on open science included in the national monitoring and evaluation framework for STI policy (ref.: [\(ii\) 17.i, 23.c](#))

⁷ Examples can include sharing open scientific knowledge (publications, research data, educational resources, software and hardware) with other scientists and with the public, sharing or using open infrastructures, collaboration with other researchers, with national and local societal actors such as policy makers, or sectors such as industry, agriculture, and health, and collaboration and open dialogue with indigenous peoples and local communities.

YES / **UNDER DEVELOPMENT** / NO

If **yes** or **under development**, please provide details and links as relevant.

- **Department of Science, Technology and Innovation (DSI) has developed the Science Engagement Monitoring and Evaluation Impact Indicator Framework**
- **National agencies and government. departments.**
- **A policy has been drafted, approval by parliament is awaited on that.**
- **National Policy on Open Science and DSC monitoring this**

3. INVESTING IN OPEN SCIENCE INFRASTRUCTURES AND SERVICES

- 3.1 What is the latest official data for your country's percentage of national gross domestic product (GDP) dedicated to research and development expenditure? Please also indicate the year of publication of this data, and to which year(s) it refers. (ref.: [\(iii\) 18.a](#))

0.62% <https://www.sanews.gov.za/south-africa/sa-records-increase-research-and-development-expenditure-after-covid-19>

- 3.2 What is the latest official data for the percentage of your country's population that have access to reliable internet and bandwidth? Please also indicate the year of publication of this data, and to which year(s) it refers. (ref.: [\(iii\) 18.b](#))

- **45.34 million people** <https://www.statista.com/statistics/685134/south-africa-digital-population/>
- **79% of people have access to internet (Source: <https://www.gov.za/blog/south-africa-connect>, Feb 2025)**

- 3.3 Are there national research and education networks (NRENs)⁸ active in the country? (ref.: [\(iii\) 18.c](#))

YES / NO

If **yes**, please provide more information and links as relevant, and indicate to which open science actors in your country those networks are accessible.

- **South African National Research Network (SANReN) and the Tertiary Education and Research Network of South Africa (TENET)**
- <https://www.sanren.ac.za/south-african-nren/>
- <https://ubuntunet.net/>

If **no**, please, if possible, briefly explain the reason and the difficulties or obstacles in this area and indicate if there are plans to establish them.

- 3.4 Are there national or institutional [open science infrastructures](#)⁹ in your country? (ref.: [\(iii\) 18.d, 18.e, 18.k, 18.l, 18.m](#))

YES / **UNDER DEVELOPMENT** / NO

⁸ A national research and education network (NREN) is a specialised internet service provider dedicated to supporting the needs of the research and education communities within a country.

⁹ Some examples of open science infrastructures include major shared scientific equipment or sets of instruments, open computational and data manipulation service infrastructures that enable collaborative and multidisciplinary data analysis, open science platforms and repositories for publications, research data and source codes, archives, open bibliometrics and scientometrics systems for assessing and analysing scientific domains, open laboratories, software forges and virtual research environments, open innovation testbeds, incubators, science museums, science parks and infrastructure for non-digital materials.

If **yes** or **under development**, please indicate which type(s) of infrastructure:

- National Integrated Cyber Infrastructure System (<https://www.nicis.ac.za/>)

For each infrastructure, please provide links as relevant and more information with regard to their compliance with the 2021 Recommendation on Open Science in terms of inclusivity, accessibility, interoperability, community governance, FAIR (Findable, Accessible, Interoperable, and Reusable) and CARE (Collective Benefit, Authority to Control, Responsibility and Ethics) principles. Please indicate if the infrastructure is non-commercial.

- **National Integrated Cyber Infrastructure System** (<https://www.nicis.ac.za/>)
- **High-performance computing clusters** (<https://www.chpc.ac.za/about-the-chpc/>)
- **NRF infrastructure platforms** (<https://www.nrf.ac.za/core-mandate-business-divisions/national-research-infrastructure-platforms/>)
- **Department of Science, Technology and Innovation infrastructure:**
 - ✓ Emerging Technologies:
 - ✓ The DSTI is driving targeted research and development of emerging technologies and their diffusion into key economic sectors.
 - ✓ Digital Inclusion:
 - ✓ The DSTI is committed to a digitally inclusive society, where all citizens have access to reliable and affordable communication services.
 - ✓ National Research Infrastructure:
 - ✓ The DSTI supports both national and international researchers by providing accessible, networked infrastructure that will foster interdisciplinary research and innovation.
 - ✓ Environmental Research:
 - ✓ The DSTI has launched EFTEON, a platform to advance environmental research and sustainability, focusing on understanding connected ecological and social systems.
 - ✓ SANReN:
 - ✓ The South African National Research Network (SANReN) initiative, funded by DSTI and implemented by CSIR Meraka Institute, provides high-speed connectivity to universities, science councils, and other entities.
 - ✓ Broadband Infrastructure:
 - ✓ The DSTI is involved in initiatives to connect public schools to the internet, such as the Wireless Mesh Network (WMN)

If **no**, please, if possible, briefly explain the reason and the difficulties or obstacles in this area and indicate if there are plans to do so.

- 3.5 Does your country host or fund any federated regional or international information technology infrastructure for open science? (ref.: [\(iii\) 18.e](#), [18.f](#))

YES / NO

If **yes**, please provide links as relevant and more information, including the name of the infrastructure, date of establishment, language, target groups and beneficiaries, governance/community agreements, scope (e.g. research areas, elements of open science¹, stage of research, accessibility to all the relevant users in the region or internationally).

- **African Open Science Platform and its Regional Nodes** (<https://www.nrf.ac.za/the-african-open-science-platform-appoints-three-regional-nodes/>)

If **no**, are the existing open science infrastructures at regional and international levels accessible to all the relevant open science actors from your country?

YES / NO

- 3.6 Is your country involved in any North-South, North-South-South and South-South collaborations to optimize infrastructure use and joint strategies for shared, multinational, regional and national open science platforms? (ref.: [\(iii\) 18.g](#))

YES / NO

If **yes**, please provide links as relevant and more information, including the name of the infrastructure, date of establishment, language, target groups and beneficiaries, governance/community agreements, scope (e.g. research areas, elements of open science¹, stage of research, accessibility to all the relevant users in the region or internationally).

- **Various research funding platforms such as NRF, agencies, councils, etc.**
<https://www.skao.int/en/partners/skao-members/397/south-africa>
<https://www.salt.ac.za/>
<https://uwcscholar.uwc.ac.za:8443/server/api/core/bitstreams/75c4d1cc-58a9-4a35-884e-b54781eda672/content>
<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/BRICS>
<https://q20.org/>
<https://www.iora.int/>
<https://sgciafrica.org/>

4. INVESTING IN HUMAN RESOURCES, TRAINING, EDUCATION, DIGITAL LITERACY AND CAPACITY BUILDING FOR OPEN SCIENCE

- 4.1 Has systematic capacity building on open science taken place in higher education and/or research performing institutions in your country? (ref.: [\(iv\) 19.a, 19.c](#))

YES / NO

If **yes**, please indicate if those capacity building initiatives are formal or informal and provide more information and links as relevant.

- formal and informal, conferences, webinars, and CPDWL
- Research funding and support

If **no**, please, if possible, briefly explain the reason and the difficulties or obstacles in this area and indicate if there are plans to do so.

- 4.2 Have capacity building programmes for policy makers on how to integrate [core values](#) and [principles](#) of open science in STI policies and strategies taken place in your country?

YES / NO

If **yes**, please provide more information and links as relevant.

- **Various higher education and university research level funding grants, industrial-institute collaborative grants, etc.**
- **NEF can answer, foundation of research support**
- **Research capacity development workshops done by universities, USAF, DHET and other research organisations**
- **Colloquiums about Open Science across institutions**

If **no**, please, if possible, briefly explain the reason and the difficulties or obstacles in this area and indicate if there are plans to do so.

- National Directive on approved policy
- National policy directives focussing more on profit making than on freely sharing knowledge.

4.3 Has a framework of open science competencies been incorporated into higher education research skills curricula in your country, or is it foreseen by the end of 2025? (ref.: [\(iv\) 19.b](#))

YES / NO

If yes, please provide more information and links as relevant.

- **Supporting science communication**
- **University research policies**
- **Awareness of Open Science has been promoted across institutions**

If no, please, if possible, briefly explain the reason and the difficulties or obstacles in this area and indicate if there are plans to do so.

4.4 Are open educational resources¹⁰ as defined in the [2019 Recommendation on Open Educational Resources](#), used as an instrument for open science capacity building in your country in line with the 2019 Recommendation mentioned above? (ref.: [\(iv\) 19.d](#))

YES / PARTLY / NO

4.5 Have there been any initiatives in your country to support science communication in line with open science value and principles with a view to the dissemination of scientific knowledge to researchers of different disciplines, decision-makers and the public at large? (ref.: [\(iv\) 19.e](#))

YES / NO

If yes, please provide more information and links as relevant.

- DHET, NRR, CSIR, NRF, etc
- <https://ufs.libguides.com/oer>
- University websites, seminars/workshops, emails

If no, please, if possible, briefly explain the reason and the difficulties or obstacles in this area and indicate if there are plans to do so.

5. FOSTERING A CULTURE OF OPEN SCIENCE AND ALIGNING INCENTIVES FOR OPEN SCIENCE

5.1 Have there been any initiatives at the national or institutional level, e.g. by universities and/or research performing institutions, to review the existing research assessment and evaluation processes in order to align them with open science principles and values or are they foreseen by the end of 2025? (ref.: [\(v\) 20.b, 20c, 20i](#))

YES / NO

If yes, please provide more information and links as relevant.

- **Department of Science and Innovation (DSI) has developed the Science Engagement Monitoring and Evaluation Impact Indicator Framework**

¹⁰ Open Educational Resources are learning, teaching and research materials in any format and medium that reside in the public domain or are under copyright that have been released under an open license, that permit no-cost access, re-use, re-purpose, adaptation and redistribution by others ([2019 Recommendation on Open Educational Resources](#))

- **Review on various plants, such as NDP2030, STI decadal, etc.**
- **University research policies**

If **no**, please, if possible, briefly explain the reason and the difficulties or obstacles in this area and indicate if there are plans to do so.

- 5.2 Have specific clauses that recognize open science practices, including sharing, collaborating and engaging with other researchers and societal actors beyond the scientific community, or dialogue with other knowledge systems, been incorporated in the career evaluation and progression systems or are foreseen by the end of 2025? (ref.: [\(v\) 20.a, 20.c, 20.d](#))

YES / NO

If **yes**, please provide details and links as relevant.

- **Open access of research is one such platform that has been developed.**
- **Visibility and impact**
- **Plagiarism Policy; Research Meetings**
- **not-scientific publications are an item in performance reviews**
- **A number of Institutions have initiatives to share and collaborate with regard to the Open Science dialogue.**

If **no**, please, if possible, briefly explain the reason and the difficulties or obstacles in this area and indicate if there are plans to do so.

- 5.3 Have there been any initiatives in your country to recognize and reward open science practices or are they foreseen by the end of 2025? (ref.: [\(v\) 20.a, 20.b, 20.c, 20.e, 20.f, 20.g, 20h](#))

YES / NO

If **yes**, for each initiative, please provide more information, including on the stakeholders¹¹ that are involved or lead the initiative, and links as relevant.

- **NRF: For the First time awarded an Societal Impact Award (<https://www.nrf.ac.za/research-impact/>) which was influenced by the shift both within government and agency towards impact and openness.**

If **no**, please, if possible, briefly explain the reason and the difficulties or obstacles in this area and indicate if there are plans to do so.

- 5.4 Have there been any unintended negative consequences¹² of open science practices reported in your country? (ref.: [\(v\) 20](#))

YES / **NO**

If **yes**, please provide more information and specify if there is a strategy or plan to preventing and mitigate such consequences.

¹¹ For example, research funders, universities, research institutions, learned societies, scientific publishers and journal editorial boards.

¹² For example, predatory behaviours, data migration, exploitation and privatization of research data, increased costs for scientists and high article processing charges associated with certain business models in scientific publishing that may be causes of inequality for the scientific communities around the world and, in some cases, the loss of intellectual property and knowledge.

6. PROMOTING INNOVATIVE APPROACHES FOR OPEN SCIENCE AT DIFFERENT STAGES OF THE SCIENTIFIC PROCESS

- 6.1 Have there been any initiatives at the national or institutional level that promote innovative, participatory methodological or procedural changes at different stages of the research cycle to increase the openness of the entire scientific process? (ref.: [\(vi\) 21](#))

YES, at the national level.

YES, at the institutional level.

YES, at both national and institutional levels.

NO

If **yes**, please indicate which of the recommended actions they address and provide more information and links as relevant:

- **Promotion of pre-prints**
- **Exploration of open peer-review practices**
- **Valuing and sharing of negative scientific results and associated data**
- **Participatory methods that value inputs from societal actors, e.g. citizen science, crowdsourcing scientific projects**
- **Development of participatory strategies for identifying the needs of marginalized communities and highlighting socially relevant issues to be incorporated into research agendas.**
- **Promoting open innovation practices.**

If **no**, please, if possible, briefly explain the reason and the difficulties or obstacles in this area and indicate if there are plans to do so.

7. PROMOTING INTERNATIONAL AND MULTI-STAKEHOLDER COOPERATION IN THE CONTEXT OF OPEN SCIENCE AND WITH VIEW TO REDUCING DIGITAL, TECHNOLOGICAL AND KNOWLEDGE GAPS

- 7.1 How is your country promoting and facilitating international scientific collaborations on open science as outlined in the 2021 Recommendation on Open Science? (ref.: [\(vii\) 22.a](#))

- **Through travel support for collaboration**
- **National and International collaboration and research**

- 7.2 Does your country have a strategy or a plan for stimulating cross-border multi-stakeholder collaboration on open science, including with regards to exchange of best practices, capacity building and metrics for open science? (ref.: [\(vii\) 22.b](#), [22.e](#), [22.f](#))

YES / NO

- If **yes**, please provide links as relevant and more information.
- Through the African Open Science Platform
- Funding Agency (NRF): Through collaborative grants where OS and impact are part of the proposal assessment and review

- Various bilateral, trilateral, Global South-North, funding based collaborations were initiated.

If **no**, please, if possible, briefly explain the reason and the difficulties or obstacles in this area and indicate if there are plans to do so.

- 7.3 Is your country involved in any discussion on the establishment of regional and international funding mechanisms for open science? (ref.: <https://unesdoc.unesco.org/ark:/48223/pf0000379949/PDF/379949eng.pdf.multi.nameddest=20/p.nameddest=20/.page=21>)

YES/ NO

If **yes**, please provide links as relevant and more information.

- ***NRF, and MRC***
- ***Department of science, technology and innovation, and its nodal agencies.***

If **no**, please, if possible, briefly explain the reason and the difficulties or obstacles in this area and indicate if there are plans to do so.

8. GENERAL CONSIDERATIONS

- 8.1 Are there any specific external causes that may impede the implementation of the 2021 UNESCO Recommendation on Open Science in your country?

YES/NO

If **yes**, please provide more information.

- ***General by-in from the Academic community***
- ***Shifting of responsibilities by all the stakeholders involved***
- ***Financial constraints***
- ***Colonial history which has influences how research, science and the academic enterprise is conducted***
- ***Academic Libraries should be given the opportunity to lead this in their respective institution and to influence the national strategy.***
- ***General lack of available national research funding to support Open Science and Open Access publications.***
- ***Country more geared towards saving money and making Open Science fund-sourcing a problem of the researchers themselves.***